

1. Legendary Mountaineer Nirmal "Nimsdai" Purja and Nepali Expedition Members Perish in Broad Peak Avalanche

Nepal's Ministry of Foreign Affairs confirms the tragic loss of the record-breaking high-altitude team during an expedition in Pakistan's Karakoram range.

KATHMANDU, August 2 — Nepal's mountaineering community has suffered a devastating loss after world-renowned climber Nirmal "Nimsdai" Purja and five fellow Nepali expedition members were killed in a massive avalanche on Pakistan's Broad Peak.

The tragic incident occurred on July 30 as the team was navigating the mountain route, leaving the climbers buried in extreme terrain.

Nepal's Ministry of Foreign Affairs officially confirmed the deaths on Sunday, expressing deep national grief over the loss of Purja and his team. The deceased Nepali climbers have been identified as Pur Bahadur Gurung, Kili Pemba Sherpa, Nima Sherpa, Nawang Thindu Sherpa, and Gyalu Sherpa.

Search and recovery operations, coordinated between Pakistani military forces and high-altitude rescue teams, were initiated shortly after contact was lost. Rescuers have begun retrieving the remains from the avalanche debris under challenging conditions.

Purja was widely celebrated as one of the most influential figures in modern mountaineering. He achieved global acclaim in 2019 through his groundbreaking "Project Possible," scaling all 14 of the world's 8,000-meter peaks in just six months and six days a feat that radically reshaped perceptions of human endurance. He further solidified his legacy in January 2021 as part of the historic team that completed the first-ever winter summit of K2.

Beyond his personal records, Purja played a key role in bringing global recognition to Nepali mountaineers and Sherpa guides, championing their technical skill and leadership in high-altitude exploration.

The Ministry of Foreign Affairs described the loss of such experienced mountain leaders as an irreparable loss for Nepal's adventure sector. Broad Peak, standing at 8,051 meters in the Karakoram range, remains one of the world's most formidable mountains, where unpredictable weather and severe avalanche threats continue to pose extreme danger to high-altitude expeditions.



2. Federal Parliament Reconvenes Following Recess with Focus on Core Legislative Bills

Lawmakers prioritize key economic, security, and governance reforms following a two-week recess.

KATHMANDU, July 29 — Nepal's Federal Parliament has resumed its regular proceedings after a two-week recess, with lawmakers turning their focus to advancing major legislative bills currently under review in parliamentary committees.

Discussions have centered on key legislation impacting economic management, national security, tourism regulation, and administrative governance. Parliamentary committees are actively conducting clause-by-clause reviews to finalize the legislation before submitting the bills to the full House for a final vote.

Among the priority measures under review is the Nepal Rastra Bank Act (Third Amendment) Bill, currently before the Finance Committee. The proposed amendment seeks to update banking regulations and reinforce the country's financial governance framework.

Meanwhile, the State Affairs Committee is examining the Nepal Special Service Act (Revival) Bill, which addresses the legal parameters governing the country's special services and administrative operations. Several other legislative proposals covering tourism regulation, intangible cultural heritage protection, and forensic laboratory standards are also moving through the committee pipeline.

Minister for Law, Justice and Parliamentary Affairs Sobita Gautam noted that government ministries are coordinating closely to prepare and register additional priority bills to ensure a productive legislative output during the monsoon session.

With several major legislative proposals awaiting final review, the resumed session is expected to focus on strengthening state institutions, addressing current economic challenges, and modernizing governance systems across key sectors.

Parliamentary committees play a crucial role in examining proposed laws by reviewing their provisions, collecting feedback, and making necessary recommendations before bills reach the full House for discussion and voting.



3. Life Returns to Normal in Eastern Madhesh Following Government De-escalation Accord

Public transit resumes and markets reopen across Madhesh and Koshi provinces as authorities and community leaders reach an understanding.

SUNSARI, August 2 — Normal daily activities have resumed across several districts in Madhesh and Koshi provinces following days of heightened regional tension triggered by a local conflict in Sunsari.

The situation has stabilized after government representatives reached an understanding with local community leaders, political representatives, and affected families, prompting authorities to gradually lift curfews and prohibitory orders across Sunsari, Siraha, Dhanusha, Saptari, and Parsa.

The unrest originated from a confrontation on July 26 in Dewanganj Rural Municipality, Sunsari, which quickly sparked security concerns throughout eastern Nepal. Following days of restricted movement, public transportation services have returned to regular schedules, and major economic hubs including markets in Janakpur, Itahari, Inaruwa and Siraha have reopened for business.

To investigate the root causes of the confrontation, a high-level committee formed under the Ministry of Home Affairs has begun its inquiry. The panel's final report is expected to offer specific recommendations on security protocols, administrative accountability, and long-term measures to maintain social harmony in the region.

District administration officials and community leaders emphasized that local disputes must be resolved through dialogue and legal avenues rather than escalating into broader social friction. Meanwhile, security forces continue to monitor sensitive areas across the affected districts to ensure lasting peace and stability.



4. Investment Strategist Deepmala Dhakal Crowned Miss Nepal 2026

The 24-year-old finance professional, athlete, and healthcare advocate will represent Nepal on the global stage.

LALITPUR, August 2 — Deepmala Dhakal has been crowned Miss Nepal World 2026 following a grand finale organized by The Hidden Treasure in Lalitpur, according to event reporting by [The Kathmandu Post](#).

Dhakal, who works as an investment strategist at global financial firm BlackRock and holds a degree in economics, secured the national title after competing against 23 other finalists, as detailed by [Ratopati](#). Her crowning highlights a growing focus in modern pageantry on professional excellence, leadership, and public service alongside traditional criteria.

Beyond her corporate background, Dhakal is a taekwondo black belt and marathon runner. She also serves as a youth coordinator for the Non-Resident Nepali Association (NRNA), helping connect second-generation diaspora communities with Nepali language and cultural heritage initiatives.

Following her victory, Dhakal reaffirmed her commitment to using the Miss Nepal platform for social advocacy, particularly health awareness and cancer care. She serves as a goodwill ambassador for the Nepal Cancer Hospital, leading campaigns focused on early detection, treatment, and healthcare access.

As Miss Nepal World 2026, Dhakal will represent the country at the upcoming global Miss World competition, as noted by [HimalPress](#).



5. World Bank Report Warns Accelerating Extreme Heat Threatens Nepal's Economy and Outdoor Workforce

A new report urges immediate heat-adaptation measures in urban centers as daily wage earners face up to 40 percent income loss.

KATHMANDU, July 30 — Nepal is facing escalating risks from rising temperatures as climate change directly undermines economic productivity, public health, and outdoor livelihoods, according to a new report from the World Bank.

The report, titled *A Livable Future: Protecting Jobs and Growth from Extreme Heat in South Asia's Cities*, warns that continued temperature increases could severely cripple urban development and economic growth across South Asia. Data from the report reveals that Nepal's average temperature has already increased by roughly 1.26°C above pre-industrial levels, positioning it among the rapidly warming nations in the region.

Urban areas are bearing the brunt of the warming, particularly within the Kathmandu Valley. Rapid construction, high population density, and disappearing green cover have intensified the "urban heat island" effect, causing city center temperatures to spike significantly higher than surrounding rural zones. Concrete structures and asphalt absorb and retain heat throughout the day, creating hazardous conditions for residents.

The economic toll is hitting daily wage earners, construction workers, farmers, and informal sector employees the hardest. The World Bank estimates that during severe heat events, outdoor laborers face income losses of up to 40 percent due to safety-mandated breaks, reduced working hours, and diminished physical capacity.

Climate change impacts in Nepal are no longer confined to melting glaciers and erratic rainfall patterns, the report emphasizes, noting that extreme heat now directly influences everyday household expenses, workplace safety, and commercial stability.

To counter these growing threats, experts are urging municipal governments to integrate heat-adaptation strategies into future urban planning. Recommended measures include cool-roof technologies, expanded urban green spaces, shaded pedestrian corridors, and climate-resilient infrastructure to protect vulnerable workers. As temperatures continue to rise, addressing extreme heat has become a major priority for Nepal's sustainable development and economic stability.

